2. Select the environment type, either Venv or Conda. This book demonstrates Venv but Conda should also work.
3. Select the Python installation. The code in this book has been run with Python 3.10 at a minimum. The agent tools and frameworks featured in this book are cutting edge, so they should support later versions of Python.
4. Check that the `requirements.txt` file in the chapter folder is selected. This will install all the requirements for the current chapter.

You should complete these steps for each new chapter of the book. The alternative is to use VS Code development containers, which will be covered in the next section.

B.6 Using VS Code Dev Containers (Docker)

When working with advanced agents and agents that can generate and execute code, running them in isolated containers is generally recommended. Container isolation prevents operating system disruption or corruption and provides a base for deploying agents.

Getting familiar with containers and platforms such as Docker can be an extensive undertaking to grasp everything. Fortunately, it takes very little knowledge to start using containers, and VS Code extensions make this even more accessible.

You'll first need to install a container toolset. Docker is free (provided you use the tool as a hobby or you're a student) and the most accessible. Follow these instructions to install Docker and get started working with containers:

1. Go to the Docker Desktop download page at www.docker.com/products/docker-desktop.
2. Download and install Docker for your operating system. Follow any other instructions as requested.
3. Launch the Docker desktop application. Completing this step will confirm you have Docker installed and working as expected.